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NEWSPLUS

Home Depot Beats Estimates, Raises Guidance for Year

Earnings were \$2.17 billion, or \$1.84 a share; analysts were expecting \$1.82 a share

By Allison Prang

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Home Depot (HD) reported third-quarter earnings that beat analysts' estimates and increased its guidance for the year partly because of hurricane-related business.

Earnings at the Atlanta-based company were \$2.17 billion, or \$1.84 a share, up from \$1.97 billion, or \$1.60 a share a year ago, the company said Tuesday. Analysts were expecting \$1.82 a share.

Net sales rose 8.1% to \$25.03 billion. Operating expenses at the company rose 5.2% to \$4.97 billion. Comparable-store sales rose 7.9%.

The hurricane negatively affected Home Depot's operating profit by \$51 million. Comparable store sales growth was helped by \$282 million by the hurricanes, but the company took on \$104 million in expenses, Home Depot said.

The company also increased its guidance and expects comparable-store sales growth for the year to increase 6.5%. It estimates earnings per share--taking into account \$8 billion worth of share buybacks--to be \$7.36, up 14% from 2016. The home improvement company was previously expecting comparable-store sales to grow by about 5.5% and earnings per share--taking into account \$7 billion worth of buybacks --to be up 13% to \$7.29.

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